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SUPERSEDING
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October 22, 1959 and
Fed. Spec. DDD-C-486a
August 22, 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

WASHCLOTH, COTTON, TERRY

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 **Scope.**—This specification covers the requirements for cotton washcloths.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276—Thread; Cotton.

CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.

PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

Fed. Std. No. 751—Stitches; Seams; and Stitching.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-3149—Baling of Clothing and Equipage.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Sample.**—Unless otherwise specified, the washcloths shall be equal to the standard

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sample in all respects not specifically covered by this specification (see 6.3).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 *Cotton.*—The cotton shall be of suitable grade and staple length to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.2.2 *Yarn.*—The yarn shall be of the ply required in table I and shall be made from cotton which has been thoroughly cleaned, well carded and evenly drawn so as to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Physical requirements.—The finished washcloths shall conform to the requirements shown in table I when tested as specified in 4.2.2.

3.3.1 *Weave.*—The fabric shall consist of a ground warp, pile warp, and filling yarns woven as a single-loop terry weave except that there shall be a plain woven border ¼ to ½ inch wide either on both sides and both ends or on both ends only. When the border is on both ends only it shall be located not more than 1 inch from the ends.

3.3.2 *Thread.*—Thread used for stitching shall be thread, cotton, ticket No. 30, 3 ply, type IA2 of Federal Specification V–T–276.

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 *Edge finishing.*—All raw edges shall be overedged stitched with 10 to 14 stitches per inch of stitch type 504 in seam and stitching type EFd–1 as specified in Federal Standard No. 751. All ends of stitching shall be overstitched ¾ to 1 inch. There shall be no loose or untrimmed threads on the finished washcloths.

3.5 Finish.—The washcloths shall be desized and bleached white, and shall contain not more than 2 percent of sizing or other nonfibrous materials when tested as specified in 4.2.2.

3.6 Marking for identification.—If a woven design, or woven, embroidered or stamped lettering is required, it shall be as specified (see 6.2). Any colors involved shall show good fastness to laundering and bleaching when tested as specified in 4.2.2.

3.7 Workmanship. — The finished washcloths shall be clean, evenly woven, and shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the levels set by the applicable acceptable quality levels.

TABLE I.—*Physical requirements*

Weight	Yarns per inch		Ply			Finished dimensions		Break. strength, grab method (minimum)	
			Warp						
Per dozen, minimum	Warp [1]	Filling [1]	Ground	Pile	Filling	Each	Tolerance	Warp	Filling
Ounces						*Inch*	*Inch*	*Lbs.*	*Lbs.*
16	68	35	2 or 1	2 or 1	1	12 by 12	±½	40	35

[1] Either of these values may fall below this minimum by not more than three yarns, provided the combined warp and filling yarn total does not fall below 100 yarns per square inch.

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4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Contractor's inspection responsibility. —Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 Inspection for acceptance. — Except when otherwise specified by Civil Government Agencies, determination of acceptabil-

Visual examination (*see 4.2.1.1.1*).

Defects	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Cut, hole, tear—any	X	
Smash—any	X	
Floats or skips:		
—Multiple, ½ inch or more in combined warp and filling directions	X	
—Multiple less than ½ inch in combined directions		X
—Single—2 inches or longer[1]		X
Broken or missing yarns, clearly visible:[1]		
—Three or more contiguous, 1 inch or more missing	X	
—Less than three, 1 inch or more missing		X
Wrong draw or reed marks clearly visible		X
Fine filling bar, light place, clearly visible	X	
Slub, slug or gout:		
—⅛ inch or more in thickness and 1 inch or more in length		X
Jerked in filling, slough off:		
—Three or more additional yarns in shed	X	
—Less than three additional yarns in shed		X
Terry loops:		
—Missing or not formed properly, pulled, 1 inch or more in combined directions	X	
—Less than 1 inch in combined warp and filling directions—clearly visible[1]		X
Spot, stain, streak, clearly visible[1]	X	
Any trash, motes, leaf or seed coat fragments		X
Objectionable odor		X
White washcloth not bleached	X	
Thread not substantially same color as cloth		X
Overstitching missing	X	
Overstitching—less than ¾ inch		X
Wrong stitch type		X
Less than twelve stitches per inch		X
More than fourteen stitches per inch		X
Loose stitch tension; resulting in a loosely secured edge		X
Raw edge over ¼ inch in length	X	
Raw edge up to and including ¼ inch in length		X
Any needle chew likely to develop into hole	X	
Ends of thread not trimmed off		X
Skipped, broken or runoff stitching more than ½ inch long	X	
Skipped, broken or runoff stitching ½ inch or less in length		X
Border omitted on either or both ends	X	
Identification marking (when specified) — omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color, misplaced	X	

[1] Clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approx. 3 feet).

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ity of product as to compliance with the requirements of this specification shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105, except as otherwise specified hereinafter.

4.2.1 *Inspection of the end item.*

4.2.1.1 *Examination.*—The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.2.1.1.1, 4.2.1.1.2, 4.2.1.1.3, 4.2.1.1.4 and 4.2.1.1.5.

4.2.1.1.1 *Visual examination.* — The required number of units shall be examined on both sides. Defects appearing on both sides of the washcloth shall be tallied only once. The unit of product shall be 1 washcloth. The acceptable quality levels shall be 2.5 major defects per hundred units (DHU) and 10.0 total DHU (Major and minor combined). The inspection level shall be level I, table IIIA of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.2.1.1.2 *Dimensional examination.* — The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level L–6, table IIIB of Military Standard MIL–STD–105. The unit of product for the examination shall be one washcloth. The acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 DHU.

Overall length and width	– less than 11½ inches
	– more than 12½ inches
Width of border	– less than ¼ inch
	– more than ½ inch

(Note: A suitable template may be used).

4.2.1.1.3 *Examination for weight.* — The unit of product shall be one dozen washcloths. Any unit that does not meet the applicable minimum weight requirements specified in table I shall be considered a defect. The inspection level shall be level L–3 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 DHU.

4.2.1.1.4 *Packaging examination.*—Bundles shall be examined for the defects listed below. The unit of product shall be one bundle. The acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 DHU. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level L–3. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 washcloth.

Defects	
Military agencies (Level A only)	Civil agencies (Levels A & B only)
More or less than 10 washcloths per bundle.	More or less than 12 washcloths per bundle.
Not evenly stacked.	Not evenly stacked.
Bundles not securely tied as specified.	Bundles not wrapped and secured as specified.

4.2.1.1.5 *Packing examination.*—The bales or shipping containers shall be examined for the defects listed below. The unit of product shall be 1 bale or 1 shipping container. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size (each)	Sample Size	
	Bale	Shipping container
800 or less	2	5
801 to 22,000	3	10
22,001 and up	5	15

The lot shall be unacceptable if any defect listed below is found in the sample.

Defects	
Military Agencies	Civil Agencies
(Levels A & B only)	(Level A only)
More or less than 100 bundles per bale.	More or less than 1,000 washcloths per bale.
Not packed in accordance with MIL–B–3149.	Not packed in accordance with MIL–B–3149.
Markings missing, incorrect, illegible or incomplete.	(Level B only)
	More or less than 25 bundles per shipping container.
	Not packed in accordance with 5.2.2.1.

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4.2.2 *Testing.*—Testing shall be conducted in accordance with methods specified in Federal Specification CCC–T–191 and as listed in table III herein for the characteristics shown therein. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a unit of product for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method. The unit of product shall be 4 washcloths. The sample size for each characteristic shall be in accordance with table II. The lot size shall be in units of product of 1 washcloth. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet a test requirement.

TABLE II.—*Sampling for tests*

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and up	5

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for supplies and equipment.

5.1 Packaging.—Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Levels A and B.*

5.1.1.1 *Civil agencies.*—Twelve identical washcloths shall be evenly stacked flat or center folded to form a bundle which shall be completely wrapped in kraft paper. Ends of wrapping shall be neatly folded and secured by either cross-tying with cotton tape or twine, or by use of adhesive or gummed kraft paper.

5.1.1.2 *Military agencies (level A).*—Ten identical washcloths shall be evenly stacked in a bundle and securely tied with cotton tape or twine.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—Washcloths shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing.—Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Civil agencies.*—One thousand washcloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a bale conforming to the requirements of Military Specification MIL–B–3149.

5.2.1.2 *Military agencies.*—One thousand washcloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a bale conforming to the requirements of Military Specification MIL–B–3149.

TABLE III.—*Test methods*

Characteristic	Reference requirement	Test method	Number of determinations per unit of product
Yarn, ply	Table I	Visual	1
Yarns, per inch	Table I	5050	5
Breaking strength	Table I	5100	5
Weave	3.3.1	Visual	1
Colorfastness (if color is specified) for identification:			
—to laundering	3.6	5610	1
—to bleaching	3.6	5600	1
Nonfibrous material	3.5	2611	2

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5.2.2 *Level B.*

5.2.2.1 *Civil agencies.* — Twenty-five wrapped bundles of 12 washcloths, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636, except that the minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 275 p.s.i. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.2 *Military agencies.*—One thousand washcloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a bale conforming to the requirements of Military Specification MIL–B–3149.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—Washcloths, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall conform to carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123. Each wrapped package of washcloths shall be labeled as follows:

Federal Stock Number
Item Identification (Nomenclature)
Quantity

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, bales shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.—Washcloths covered by this specification are intended for use by the Federal agencies and the Department of Defense.

6.2 Ordering data. — Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. When identification is required, color and pattern shall be specified (see 3.6).
c. Both the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Standard sample.—For access to standard sample, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 Transportation description.—The transportation description and minimum weight applicable to this commodity is:

Rail:
Cloths, wash, made wholly of cotton.
Carload minimum weight—Any quantity.
Motor:
Dry Goods, not otherwise indexed.
Motor volume minimum weight—Any quantity.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—M Q
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Air Force

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